BABYSTEPS · PROJECT DOCUMENT

Project charter

The agreement on what BabySteps is for, who is involved, how long each phase takes and how the project is judged.

PROJECT
BabySteps

PREPARED BY
Aditi Kela, product lead

VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

PROJECT
BabySteps, an AI parenting companion for first-time parents CONFIRMED

PROJECT OWNER
Aditi Kela, product lead and designer CONFIRMED

FUNDING
Self-funded personal project CONFIRMED

PLATFORM
Web app hosted on Base44 CONFIRMED

BUILD METHOD
Spec for each feature, built by directing Claude Code, reviewed against the Figma designs CONFIRMED

IN-APP AI
Guidance generated with the Claude API CONFIRMED

Purpose

New parents collect advice from many places, and much of it ignores where they live. Food guidance, vaccine schedules, growth standards and financial advice change by country, yet most baby apps give one answer to everyone. BabySteps puts tracking and memory-keeping in one app and uses the parent's country to set units, the vaccine schedule and regional guidance. CONFIRMED

Objectives

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE OF SUCCESS	TARGET	BASIS
1	Ship a working app covering the daily log, health and growth, age-aware guides and a memory vault	Feature areas live in the app	4 of 4	CONFIRMED Met

#	OBJECTIVE	MEASURE OF SUCCESS	TARGET	BASIS
2	Make guidance country-aware	Countries with their own units, vaccine schedule and guidance	2 live (US and India)	CONFIRMED Met
3	Learn from real parents before adding more features	Completed interviews or survey responses	8 to 10 interviews, 30 survey responses	PROPOSED
4	Add an AI chatbot for questions the guides do not answer	Chatbot released; answers rated helpful in testing	At least 80% rated helpful in the first test round	PROPOSED target
5	Add a shared time capsule so family can contribute letters	Shared capsule released; invited contributors who add an entry	At least 1 contributor in 50% of shared capsules	PROPOSED target
6	Keep running cost low while the user base is small	Monthly cost at 100 active families	Under $100 a month	ESTIMATE see budget

Deliverables

- Figma flows and screens for every feature CONFIRMED
- Written spec for each feature, used to direct the build CONFIRMED
- Working web app with country-aware settings, daily log, growth charts, guides and memory vault CONFIRMED
- A 45-second walkthrough video and app screenshots for the portfolio CONFIRMED
- Next release: chatbot and shared time capsule CONFIRMED in progress
- Research findings report after the interview round PROPOSED

Stakeholders and roles

WHO	ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY	BASIS
Aditi Kela	Product lead and designer	Chooses the problem, the flows and what ships. Writes the spec. Reviews all output against the designs.	CONFIRMED
Claude Code	Build assistant	Writes the code from each feature spec.	CONFIRMED
Claude API	In-app guidance	Generates the age and country guidance shown in the app.	CONFIRMED
First-time parents	Target users	Supply the problems, the language and the test feedback.	CONFIRMED audience, PROPOSED participation
Northeastern Expo 2026 visitors	Early audience	Saw the app when it was presented.	CONFIRMED

Timeline

Durations are project weeks, not calendar dates. The completed phases show what the project involved. Their lengths are my reconstruction and need your correction. TO CONFIRM

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS	DURATION	STATUS	BASIS
1. Frame the problem	Define the parent, the pain and the one big idea (country-aware guidance)	1 week	Complete	ESTIMATE
2. Design in Figma	Flows and screens for home, log, learn, profile and memory	2 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
3. Spec and build	One written spec per feature, built with Claude Code	4 weeks	Complete	ESTIMATE
4. Review and fix	Compare the build with the Figma designs and correct the gaps	1 week	Complete	ESTIMATE
5. Show it	Northeastern Expo 2026	1 event	Complete	CONFIRMED
6. Parent research	8 to 10 interviews, a 30-response survey, synthesis	3 weeks	Next	PROPOSED
7. Chatbot	Design, build and test the AI chatbot	3 weeks	In progress	CONFIRMED started, ESTIMATE length
8. Shared time capsule	Invite family, collect entries, lock until a date	3 weeks	In progress	CONFIRMED started, ESTIMATE length
9. Closed beta	20 to 30 families use the app for 4 weeks and give feedback	5 weeks	Planned	PROPOSED

Rough total for phases 1 to 5: about 9 weeks of effort. Phases 6 to 9 add about 14 weeks if run one after another, or about 9 if research runs alongside the chatbot.

ESTIMATE

Milestones and decision gates

GATE	QUESTION TO ANSWER	EVIDENCE REQUIRED
G1: Design sign-off	Do the Figma flows cover every feature in scope?	All screens reviewed against the scope document
G2: Build sign-off	Does each feature match its spec and design?	Spec checklist passed, side-by-side with Figma
G3: Research gate	Do parents want the chatbot and shared capsule as planned?	Interview themes and survey results support or change the scope
G4: Beta gate	Is the app safe and accurate enough for outside families?	Accuracy review of vaccine schedules and guidance, privacy checklist done

Risks

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
Health guidance or vaccine schedules are wrong or out of date	Medium	High	Source each schedule from the national body (for India, the IAP; for the US, the CDC), show the source in the app and review before each release

RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION
AI guidance reads as medical advice	Medium	High	Label guidance as information, add a "talk to your pediatrician" line, limit the chatbot to non-diagnostic topics
Baby and family data is sensitive	Medium	High	Collect the minimum, explain what is stored, support deletion, review hosting settings before beta
Sign-in blocks people from seeing the app	High	Medium	Offer a demo account and a walkthrough video
AI usage cost grows faster than users	Low	Medium	Use the smaller model for routine guidance and set a monthly cost cap
Solo builder time	High	Medium	Keep each phase to three weeks or less and cut scope before moving a date

Assumptions and constraints

- One person leads design, product and review. The AI writes the code. CONFIRMED
- Tooling stays on free or low-cost plans. PROPOSED
- The app is a web app. A native app is outside this charter. CONFIRMED
- Any claim about parents' needs stays a hypothesis until the research phase finishes. PROPOSED

Approval

NAME	ROLE	VERSION	DATE
Aditi Kela	Project owner and product lead	1.0, draft for review	October 15, 2026

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Scope statement

The boundary of the project. If something is not listed as in scope, it needs a change request before it is built.

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Scope in one paragraph

BabySteps is a web app that helps first-time parents track their baby's days, watch growth and health, read guidance for the baby's age, and keep memories. The parent's country decides the measurement units, the vaccine schedule and the regional guidance, including finance and savings topics. CONFIRMED

In scope

- Country-aware profile, units, vaccine schedule and guidance for the US and India CONFIRMED
- Daily log, growth and health charts, age-aware guides, finance and savings topics CONFIRMED
- Memory vault with photos, videos and a locked time-capsule letter CONFIRMED
- Chatbot and shared time capsule, the next release CONFIRMED
- Parent research, closed beta and an accuracy review of health content PROPOSED

Out of scope

- Diagnosis, treatment advice or any replacement for a pediatrician PROPOSED
- Native iOS or Android apps. The product is a web app. CONFIRMED
- Telehealth, appointments or messaging with clinicians PROPOSED
- Selling products, a marketplace or in-app payments for goods PROPOSED
- Pregnancy tracking, since the product starts at birth PROPOSED
- A public community forum PROPOSED

Requirements

ID	REQUIREMENT	PRIORITY (MOSCOW)	STATUS	BASIS
F1	Country selection sets units, vaccine schedule and regional guidance	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
F2	Baby profile with the chosen country (US and India shown)	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
F3	Home screen with today's snapshot and quick actions	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
F4	Daily log for diapers, feeds and sleep	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
F5	Food ideas based on the baby's diet type	Should	Built	CONFIRMED
F6	Health and growth charts (WHO standards when India is selected)	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
F7	Learn: guides for the baby's age	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
F8	Learn: finance and savings topics for the parent's country	Should	Built	CONFIRMED
F9	Memory vault with photos and videos	Must	Built	CONFIRMED
F10	Locked time-capsule letter	Should	Built	CONFIRMED
F11	AI chatbot for questions the guides do not cover	Should	In progress	CONFIRMED
F12	Shared time capsule with family contributors	Should	In progress	CONFIRMED
F13	Demo account for portfolio visitors	Could	Planned	PROPOSED
F14	Reminders for vaccine dates	Could	Not started	PROPOSED
F15	Add a third country	Could	Not started	PROPOSED

> MoSCoW labels are my proposed priorities. Status for F1 to F12 comes from the app and the portfolio walkthrough. CONFIRMED

Acceptance criteria

AREA	THE FEATURE IS ACCEPTED WHEN
Country settings	Choosing a country changes the units, the vaccine schedule and the guidance on the next screen without a reload
Daily log	A parent can record a diaper, feed or sleep entry in two taps from home, and it appears in the day's summary
Growth	A weight or height entry plots on the chart for the chosen standard (WHO for India)
Guides	Guides shown match the baby's age and the chosen country
Time capsule	A letter cannot be opened before its unlock date
Chatbot	Answers stay on non-diagnostic topics and point to a clinician for medical questions

Constraints and assumptions

- One product lead; the AI writes the code under written specs. CONFIRMED
- Budget stays near zero cash cost until beta. See the budget document. ESTIMATE
- Vaccine schedules come from published national schedules and must be reviewed for currency before each release. PROPOSED

Dependencies

DEPENDENCY	WHY IT MATTERS	OWNER
Base44 hosting and app visibility settings	Controls who can open the app and whether sign-in is required	Aditi
Claude API availability and pricing	Powers guidance and the planned chatbot	Aditi
National vaccine schedules (CDC, IAP)	Source for the schedule feature	Aditi
Figma files	Reference for design review	Aditi

Change control

1. Write the change as one sentence plus the reason.
2. Score it with MoSCoW and note the effort in days.
3. If it is a Must or removes risk, add it and move something of equal size out.
4. Otherwise, add it to the backlog and review at the next gate.
5. Record the decision and date in this document.

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User research plan and template

A ready-to-run plan for talking to first-time parents. Findings stay empty until the sessions happen.

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> Findings are not included. No interviews have been run for this document, and no result is invented here. Fill in the findings log after the sessions. TO CONFIRM

Goals

- Learn how first-time parents track feeds, sleep, diapers, growth and vaccines today.
- Test whether country-specific guidance (units, vaccine schedule, finance topics) matters to them.
- Find out how they keep memories and who they would share a time capsule with.
- Decide whether the chatbot and the shared time capsule deserve to be built next.

Research questions

#	QUESTION	DECISION IT INFORMS
RQ1	What do parents use today to track their baby, and what makes them stop?	Whether the daily log needs to be simpler
RQ2	Where do parents look for health, food and money guidance, and do they trust it?	How guidance is sourced and labeled
RQ3	Does living in a different country from family or advice sources change what they need?	Whether country-awareness is the lead message
RQ4	How do they handle vaccines and appointments?	Whether to add reminders
RQ5	Which questions would they ask a chatbot, and what would make them distrust it?	Chatbot scope and guardrails
RQ6	Who would they invite to a shared time capsule, and what would they write or add?	Shared capsule design

Method

METHOD	SAMPLE	LENGTH	PURPOSE
Semi-structured interview	8 to 10 parents	30 to 40 minutes	Depth on habits and needs (RQ1 to RQ6)
Concept and usability test	Same participants, last 10 minutes	10 minutes	Five tasks on the working app
Short survey	30 or more responses	4 minutes	Check how common the interview themes are

> Sample sizes are my proposal. Eight to ten interviews is usually enough to see repeated themes. A survey of 30 gives direction, not statistics. PROPOSED

Who to recruit

GROUP	COUNT	WHY
Parent of a baby aged 0 to 12 months, living in the US	3 to 4	Core user for the US schedule
Parent of a baby aged 0 to 12 months, living in India	3 to 4	Core user for the IAP schedule and metric units
Parent living away from their home country	2	Tests the country-awareness idea directly
Grandparent or partner who would contribute to a time capsule	1 to 2	Tests the shared capsule

Screener questions

1. Do you have a child under 18 months, or are you expecting your first? (Continue if yes.)
2. Is this your first child? (Prefer yes; include at most 2 second-time parents.)
3. Which country do you live in now? Which country did you grow up in?
4. Which apps, notes or paper do you use to track your baby today?
5. Are you comfortable being recorded for note-taking? You can stop at any time. (Required)

Recruitment

- Message friends of friends, student groups and community groups with a short note and the screener link. PROPOSED
- Offer a small thank-you, such as a gift card. Amount to be set by the budget. PROPOSED
- Do not recruit through the app's own users until the beta. PROPOSED

Consent and care

- Explain the purpose, the recording and how notes are stored before starting.
- Do not ask for the baby's medical records, photos or any identifying health detail.
- Store notes under a participant code, not a name. Delete recordings after synthesis.
- Offer to stop at any point. Treat parenting stress as sensitive and keep the tone warm.

Interview guide (35 minutes)

TIME	SECTION	PROMPTS
0:00	Opening (3 min)	Thank them, explain the goal, ask permission to record. "Tell me about your baby and how the last month has been."
0:03	Current habits (8 min)	"Walk me through yesterday." "What do you write down, and where?" "What did you stop tracking and why?"
0:11	Guidance and trust (8 min)	"When you had a question about feeding, sleep or vaccines, where did you look?" "Was anything wrong for where you live?" "Have you thought about saving or planning money for your baby? Where did you find advice?"
0:19	Memories (4 min)	"How do you keep photos and moments?" "Who sees them?" "Would you write something to read in the future? To whom?"
0:23	Concept test (8 min)	Show BabySteps. Five tasks below. Ask them to think aloud.
0:31	Wrap-up (4 min)	"What would make you use this weekly?" "What would make you delete it?" "Anything I should have asked?"

Usability tasks

TASK	SUCCESS MEASURE
Create a baby profile and choose your country	Done without help in under 2 minutes
Log a diaper change and a feed	Done in under 1 minute
Find the vaccine schedule for your country	Found without prompting
Find a finance or savings guide	Found without prompting
Add a photo and write a locked letter	Done without help

Survey (12 questions)

1. Your country of residence (list).
2. Baby's age band.
3. First child? (yes/no)
4. How do you track your baby today? (multi-select)
5. How often do you track? (daily, a few times a week, rarely)
6. Which topics did you search for guidance on? (feeding, sleep, vaccines, growth, money, other)
7. How much do you trust online baby advice? (1 to 5)
8. Has advice ever not applied where you live? (yes/no/unsure; if yes, describe)
9. How important is a vaccine schedule for your country? (1 to 5)
0. Would you use a chatbot for baby questions? (yes/maybe/no; why)
1. Would you share a time capsule with family? (yes/maybe/no; with whom)
2. Any other comment (optional).

Note-taking template

PARTICIPANT	DATE	COUNTRY	BABY AGE	QUOTE	OBSERVATION	THEME TAG	NEED OR PAIN
P01							
P02							
P03							

Synthesis method

1. Write each quote or observation on its own note, with the participant code.
2. Group notes into themes on an affinity map. Name each theme as a sentence.
3. Count how many participants raised each theme. A theme needs at least 3 participants to count as a pattern.
4. Turn each pattern into an insight, then into a "How might we" question.
5. Compare insights with the scope document and propose changes through change control.

Findings log (complete after the sessions)

THEME	PARTICIPANTS RAISING IT	EVIDENCE (SHORT QUOTE)	INSIGHT	CHANGE TO SCOPE

Schedule

WEEK	ACTIVITY
1	Finalize screener and guide, run 2 pilot sessions, recruit
2	Run 8 interviews, open the survey
3	Close the survey, synthesize, write the findings report, review at gate G3

How the research changes decisions

IF WE HEAR	THEN WE
Parents trust local sources and want the schedule shown with its source	Make the source label prominent and add national body links
Few parents would use a chatbot	Delay the chatbot and invest in search inside the guides
Parents want family contributions	Prioritize the shared time capsule
Tracking fatigue is the main reason people quit	Cut log fields and add one-tap entries

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Ideation and prioritization

How the idea space was opened up and narrowed, and which ideas come next.

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Problem statement

First-time parents need one place to track their baby's days, understand health and growth, and keep memories, but the advice they find ignores the country they live in. How might BabySteps give each parent guidance that fits their country and keeps the early months easy to record? CONFIRMED

How might we

- HMW show the right vaccine schedule and growth standard for the country a family lives in?
- HMW make logging a feed or diaper take two taps?
- HMW give financial and savings guidance without sounding like a bank?
- HMW help parents answer small questions late at night without sending them to a forum?
- HMW let grandparents and partners add to a baby's memories without joining another app?
- HMW make parents trust AI-written guidance? PROPOSED

Proto-personas

> These two personas are hypotheses built from the product idea. Replace them with research-based personas after the interview round. PROPOSED

	MAYA, 31, LIVES IN THE US	ROHAN, 30, LIVES IN INDIA
Situation	First baby, partner works long hours, family is overseas	First baby, lives with parents, uses Hindi and English
Needs	A fast log, a clear US vaccine schedule, ways to save for the future	Metric units, the IAP schedule, WHO growth standards, food ideas by diet type

	MAYA, 31, LIVES IN THE US	ROHAN, 30, LIVES IN INDIA
Worries	Missing a vaccine, trusting advice from strangers	Conflicting advice from family and the internet
Would pay for	Shared capsule so overseas family can add to it	Reminders and a clear growth chart

Jobs to be done

- When I am tired and just fed the baby, I want to record it in seconds so I can go back to rest.
- When it is time for a check-up, I want the right vaccine schedule for my country so I do not miss one.
- When I think about the future, I want guidance on money for my country so I feel prepared.
- When something special happens, I want to save it and write to my child so they can read it later.

Idea list

THEME	IDEAS	STATUS
Tracking	Quick log widgets; one-tap repeat of the last feed; sleep summary; weekly digest	Daily log built CONFIRMED; others PROPOSED
Health	Country vaccine schedule; vaccine reminders; growth charts by standard; summary for the pediatrician	Schedule and charts built CONFIRMED; others PROPOSED
Guidance	Age guides; food ideas by diet type; finance and savings topics; chatbot	Guides and finance topics built CONFIRMED; chatbot in progress CONFIRMED
Memory	Photos and videos; locked letter; shared capsule; printable keepsake book	Vault and letter built CONFIRMED; shared capsule in progress CONFIRMED; book PROPOSED
Trust	Source labels on every guide; "ask your pediatrician" prompts; review dates	PROPOSED

Prioritization (RICE)

RICE is Reach times Impact times Confidence, divided by Effort. Reach is families per year, Impact is 0.5 to 3, Confidence is a percentage and Effort is person-weeks. All inputs are my proposed estimates, not measurements. PROPOSED

RANK	IDEA	REACH	IMPACT	CONFIDENCE	EFFORT	RICE SCORE
1	Country-aware vaccine schedule with source label	20,000	3.0	90%	3	18,000.0
2	One-tap quick log widgets on home	20,000	1.5	80%	2	12,000.0
3	Vaccine date reminders	15,000	2.0	80%	3	8,000.0
4	Chatbot for questions the guides do not cover	20,000	2.0	60%	6	4,000.0
5	Weekly summary for the pediatrician visit	10,000	2.0	60%	4	3,000.0
6	Shared time capsule with family contributors	10,000	2.0	70%	5	2,800.0
7	Money milestones checklist by country	12,000	1.0	60%	3	2,400.0

RANK	IDEA	REACH	IMPACT	CONFIDENCE	EFFORT	RICE SCORE
8	Printable keepsake book from the memory vault	8,000	1.0	50%	6	666.7

> Confidence stays low for ideas that depend on research not yet done. Rerun this table after the interview round. PROPOSED

MoSCoW view

MUST	SHOULD	COULD	WILL NOT (THIS RELEASE)
Country-aware schedule with source label	Chatbot with guardrails	Printable keepsake book	Telehealth
Quick, two-tap logging	Shared time capsule	Money milestones checklist	Marketplace
Safe-use labels on health content	Vaccine reminders	Weekly pediatrician summary	Native apps

Decisions already made

DECISION	REASON	BASIS
Design in Figma before building	Fix structure on paper before spending build time	CONFIRMED
Country sets units, vaccine schedule and regional guidance	The idea that separates BabySteps from generic baby apps	CONFIRMED
Keep tracking and memory in one app	Parents should not juggle two apps	CONFIRMED
Add chatbot and shared capsule next	Chosen as the next features	CONFIRMED

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Competitive analysis

Where BabySteps stands against the apps parents already use, and what the gap means.

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> Research accessed October 15, 2026. "Not found" means the page I read did not say. It does not prove the feature is absent. Android coverage and several prices could not be checked on first-party pages. SOURCED

Overview

APP	PLATFORMS FOUND	TRACKING	GROWTH AND HEALTH	AI	PRICING FOUND
Huckleberry	Android (BlueStacks page); iOS implied	Sleep, diapers, feeds, pumping, growth, milestones, medicine	Growth trend tracking; vaccines not found	SweetSpot nap predictions; Berry AI chat	Free. Plus $5.74/mo billed yearly. Premium $9.99/mo billed yearly.
Baby Tracker (Nighp)	Apple devices; Android not found	Feeds, sleep, diapers, medications, temperature	WHO growth standards; vaccinations logged	On-device "What's Next" suggestions	Core free. Remove Ads $4.99. Plus $5.99/mo or $49.99/yr.
Glow Baby	Apple devices; Android not found	Feeds, nursing, pumping, sleep, diapers	Growth and development tracking; vaccines not found	"AI-powered insights"	Free. Premium $59.99/yr (Japan storefront; US mirror from 2022).
Baby Tracker (Sprout)	Apple devices	Feeds, pumping, sleep, diapers, mood	WHO and CDC charts; vaccinations, doctor visits, medications with reminders	Not found	Free with 1-week trial. Yearly $59.99 and $89.99 per a third-party mirror.

APP	PLATFORMS FOUND	TRACKING	GROWTH AND HEALTH	AI	PRICING FOUND
Baby Connect	Conflicting: app stores plus web, or iOS only	Feeds, diapers, sleep, mood, medicines, vaccinations, temperature	US or international percentile charts	Not found	7-day trial. Family $4.99/mo or $39.99/yr per an April 2024 mirror.

Feature gap

FEATURE	HUCKLEBERRY	NIGHP	GLOW	SPROUT	BABY CONNECT	BABYSTEPS
Daily log	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes CONFIRMED
Growth charts	Yes	WHO	Yes	WHO, CDC	US or international	WHO when India is selected CONFIRMED
Vaccine tracking	Not found	Logging	Not found	Logging, reminders	Logging	Schedule by country CONFIRMED
Country-specific vaccine schedule	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes CONFIRMED
Country-specific units and guidance	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes CONFIRMED
Finance and savings guidance	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Not found	Yes, by country CONFIRMED
Time-capsule letters	Not found	Not found	Not found	Printed keepsake book (nearest)	Not found	Locked letter CONFIRMED; shared version in progress
Caregiver sync	Yes	Yes	Not found	Yes	Yes	Not built yet
AI guidance or chat	Yes	Light	Insights	Not found	Not found	AI guidance CONFIRMED ; chatbot in progress

Where competitors are stronger

- Sleep prediction and sleep plans at Huckleberry, with several years of product polish.
- Caregiver sync across devices at four of the five apps.
- Reminders for vaccines and appointments at Sprout.
- Community and comparison content at Glow.
- A free tier that already covers everyday logging, so a new app has to offer something different.

Where BabySteps can stand apart

- Guidance that follows the parent's country, including the vaccine schedule and finance topics. None of the five showed this in the pages read.
- One place for tracking and memories, ending in a letter the child can read later.
- A product designed and reviewed against a written spec, so features can be explained and defended.

Implications

- Lead the story with country-awareness, since that is the clearest gap. PROPOSED
- Add caregiver sharing through the shared time capsule, then consider full sync. PROPOSED
- Source and date every vaccine schedule in the app, since a wrong schedule would hurt trust. PROPOSED
- Do not compete on sleep prediction. PROPOSED
- Price near the market: paid tiers found run from about $5 to $10 a month. SOURCED

Sources

- Huckleberry: huckleberrycare.com/pricing (undated); bluestacks.com/campaign/com.huckleberry_labs.app/en; screensdesign.com/showcase/huckleberry-baby-child
- Baby Tracker (Nighp): apps.apple.com/app/appname/id779656557
- Glow Baby: apps.apple.com/JP/app/id1077177456; screensdesign.com/showcase/glow-baby-tracker-growth-app; adapty.io/paywall-library/glow/ (2022 screenshots)
- Baby Tracker (Sprout): apps.appfollow.io/ios/baby-tracker/551448817 (updated 2024-10-03); apppricinglab.com/iap/apple/551448817 (checked 2026-04-26)
- Baby Connect: appfollow.io/ios/baby-connect-newborn-tracker/326574411; adapty.io/paywall-library/baby-connect/ (April 2024)

Limits of this analysis

- I could not load live Google Play listings, so Android coverage is unverified for most apps.
- Several prices come from third-party mirrors and may be stale.
- BabyCenter was read but left out because it focuses on pregnancy.
- Feature claims come from store listings, not from using each app. Hands-on testing would raise confidence.

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Growth plan

How BabySteps could find its first families and keep them. Every target is a proposal until the app has real usage data.

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> The app has no usage baseline in this document. Targets below are proposals to test, not forecasts. TO CONFIRM

Position and audience

- Position: the baby app that fits the country you live in. PROPOSED
- First audience: first-time parents in the US and India, plus parents living away from their home country. PROPOSED
- Secondary audience: grandparents and partners who contribute to a shared time capsule. PROPOSED

North Star metric

Weekly active families: families who log at least three days in a week. It rewards a habit, not a signup. PROPOSED

METRIC	WHY IT MATTERS	STARTING TARGET
Weekly active families	Shows the habit has formed	50 within 90 days of beta
Week-4 retention	Shows value after the novelty fades	Above 30% of new families
Entries per active family per week	Depth of use	At least 10
Time to first log	Ease of starting	Under 3 minutes from signup
Invited contributors per shared capsule	Drives the sharing loop	At least 1

All targets are proposed. PROPOSED

Funnel

STAGE	QUESTION	WHAT TO MEASURE	IDEA TO TEST
Awareness	Do parents know it exists?	Visits to the app and portfolio link	Short walkthrough video; posts in parent and expat groups
Acquisition	Do they create a profile?	Signup rate from visits	Open demo mode without sign-in
Activation	Do they log once and see their schedule?	Share who log within 24 hours	Pre-filled country and age; one-tap first log
Retention	Do they come back each week?	Week-1 and week-4 return	Vaccine reminders; weekly digest
Referral	Do they invite family?	Invites sent per family	Shared time capsule invitation
Revenue	Would they pay?	Willingness-to-pay answers	Test a premium plan near $4 to $6 a month

Growth loops

- Shared capsule loop: a parent invites a grandparent, the grandparent adds a letter, the parent returns to read and invites others. PROPOSED
- Country loop: a parent living abroad shares the country schedule with another parent from the same country. PROPOSED

Channels

CHANNEL	FIT	COST	FIRST TEST
Parent and new-parent groups, with permission from group admins	High	Time only	Post a walkthrough and ask for 10 testers
University and community networks of international students and families	Medium	Time only	Share with student groups that have parents
Pediatric clinics and doulas as referrers	Medium	Time, needs trust	Ask 3 for feedback, not for promotion
Short video of the country switch (US to India)	High	Time only	Publish one clip and track visits
Paid ads	Low until retention is proven	Money	Not before the beta gate

Experiment backlog

#	HYPOTHESIS	TEST	SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE
1	Showing the country switch in the first 10 seconds raises signup	Compare two landing versions	Signup rate up by 20% or more
2	A demo mode without sign-in raises activation	Offer demo account for 2 weeks	More first logs in 24 hours
3	Vaccine reminders raise week-4 retention	Reminders for half of new families	Retention up by 10 points
4	Family invitations bring new users	Prompt inviting after the first letter	At least 1 in 4 families invite someone

#	HYPOTHESIS	TEST	SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE
5	Parents will pay for shared capsule and reminders	Price test in interviews	At least 3 of 8 say yes at $4 a month

> Thresholds are proposals. Set them before each test so results are not bent afterward. PROPOSED

90-day plan

DAYS	FOCUS	OUTPUT
1 to 30	Parent research, fix onboarding, add demo mode	Findings report; demo account
31 to 60	Closed beta with 20 to 30 families; instrument events	Baseline for activation and retention
61 to 90	Run experiments 1 to 4; launch shared capsule invite	First growth read-out and go or no-go on paid plan

Tracking needed

- Events: signup, profile created, first log, log per day, guide opened, vaccine schedule opened, capsule created, invite sent, invite accepted.
- A weekly dashboard of the five metrics above.
- Privacy: events carry no health details, only counts.

Risks

- Parents are tired and time-poor, so onboarding must be very short.
- Health content is sensitive. One wrong schedule can undo trust.
- Free competitors cover everyday logging. Growth depends on the country angle and family sharing.

BABYSTEPS · PROJECT DOCUMENT

Budget

What it costs to run BabySteps now and at 100, 1,000 and 5,000 active families.

PROJECT
BabySteps

PREPARED BY
Aditi Kela, product lead

VERSION
1.0, draft for review

DATE
October 15, 2026

CONFIRMED from the built app or from you ESTIMATE my working figure
PROPOSED a plan or target to test SOURCED from a cited public page TO CONFIRM needs your input

> Prices below come from public pricing pages read on the dates shown. Usage numbers are my assumptions and are marked Estimate. Replace them with real usage once the app has it. ESTIMATE

Summary

At 100 active families the app costs roughly $93 a month with the larger model or $53 with the smaller one, almost all of it hosting. At 1,000 families the AI line starts to matter. The smaller model keeps the AI cost under $21 a month at that size. ESTIMATE

Pricing inputs

ITEM	PRICE	SOURCE	BASIS
Claude Sonnet 5.5	$2 per million input tokens, $10 per million output tokens	platform.claude.com/docs/en/about-claude/pricing, read 2026-10-15	SOURCED
Claude Haiku 5.5	$0.10 per million input tokens, $0.50 per million output tokens (prompts up to 100K tokens)	Same page	SOURCED
Base44 Free	$0; 25 message credits, 5 a day	softr.io comparison article, published 2026-07-15	SOURCED
Base44 Starter	$20 a month ($16 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED
Base44 Builder	$50 a month ($40 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED
Base44 Pro	$100 a month ($80 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED
Base44 Elite	$200 a month ($160 billed annually)	Same article	SOURCED

ITEM	PRICE	SOURCE	BASIS
Figma	Free plan for personal use	Assumed from current practice; verify	ESTIMATE
Custom domain	About $12 to $20 a year	General market range; verify at a registrar	ESTIMATE

> The Base44 prices come from a third-party article, not Base44's own page, which I could not read. Check the live pricing before you pick a plan. A private app needs a paid plan. TO CONFIRM

Usage assumptions

- Each active family triggers 12 guidance requests a month, each with about 1,200 input and 500 output tokens. ESTIMATE
- Planned chatbot: 6 conversations a month per active family, 6 turns each, about 2,500 input and 400 output tokens per turn. ESTIMATE
- Whether the app calls the Claude API directly or through Base44's built-in integrations decides how this cost is billed. The tables assume direct API pricing. TO CONFIRM

AI cost per month

ACTIVE FAMILIES	GUIDANCE, SONNET	GUIDANCE, HAIKU	CHATBOT, SONNET	CHATBOT, HAIKU	TOTAL, SONNET	TOTAL, HAIKU
100	$8.88	$0.44	$32.40	$1.62	$41.28	$2.06
1,000	$88.80	$4.44	$324.00	$16.20	$412.80	$20.64
5,000	$444.00	$22.20	$1,620.00	$81.00	$2,064.00	$103.20

Monthly run cost by scenario

Hosting uses Base44 Builder at $50 for 100 and 1,000 families and Pro at $100 for 5,000. The domain adds about $1.25 a month. ESTIMATE

ACTIVE FAMILIES	HOSTING	TOTAL WITH SONNET	TOTAL WITH HAIKU	YEAR, SONNET	YEAR, HAIKU
100	$50	$92.53	$53.31	$1,110	$640
1,000	$50	$464.05	$71.89	$5,569	$863
5,000	$100	$2,165.25	$204.45	$25,983	$2,453

One-time and project costs

ITEM	COST	NOTES	BASIS
Design and build tools so far	$0 to $50	Figma free; Claude subscriptions used for the build are not counted here	ESTIMATE
Research thank-you gift cards	$150 to $250	10 interviews at $15 to $25	ESTIMATE

ITEM	COST	NOTES	BASIS
Survey tool	$0	Free form tool	ESTIMATE
Legal and privacy review before public launch	$0 to $500	Template policy, or a short consultation	ESTIMATE
Contingency (15%)	Add 15% to the total of the items above		PROPOSED

> Labor is not charged. Effort is estimated at about 9 weeks for phases 1 to 5, and about 9 to 14 weeks for the research, chatbot, shared capsule and beta phases. See the charter. ESTIMATE

Break-even view

At 1,000 active families and the smaller model, monthly cost is about $72. A $4.99 monthly plan would need about 15 paying families to cover it, before payment fees. That is about 1.5% of 1,000 families. ESTIMATE

Cost controls

- Use the smaller model for routine guides and keep the larger one for the chatbot.
- Cache generated guides by country and age, so the same guide is not generated twice.
- Set a monthly spending limit in the API console and alert at 80%.
- Review the bill each month during the beta.

Open items

- Confirm which Base44 plan the app uses today. TO CONFIRM
- Confirm how the app calls Claude: direct key or Base44 integration. TO CONFIRM
- Confirm real monthly active families when beta starts. TO CONFIRM